Customer Success Escalation Guide

Owner: Hannah Kim, Customer Success Manager. Reviewed by Sofia Lindqvist (Compliance) for sections 5 and 6. Last updated 28 August 2026.

This guide tells Support and Customer Success when and how to escalate a merchant problem, and what to say while we fix it.

1. Priorities and response targets

Priority	Definition	First response	Updates	Hours
P1	Merchant cannot take card payments, or cannot pay staff on pay day	30 minutes	Every hour	24/7
P2	A product is degraded or partly failing for the merchant	4 business hours	Every business day	Support hours
P3	Question, how-to, or a problem with a workaround	1 business day	When there is news	Support hours
P4	Feature request or feedback	5 business days	None	Support hours

Support hours are 07:00 to 22:00 UK time, 7 days a week. Support works from the London and Lisbon offices on weekdays and from home at weekends, when the offices are closed. P1 cases outside those hours go straight to the Payments on-call engineer through PagerDuty.

2. Tiers

Tier	Who	Handles
Tier 1	Support team	All new cases, known issues, how-to questions
Tier 2	Customer Success Managers (Hannah Kim leads)	P1 and P2 cases, complaints, credits, anything Tier 1 cannot solve in 1 business day
Tier 3	Engineering on call, through the incident process	Suspected outages, bugs, data problems

3. When to escalate to Engineering

Raise an incident (page Payments on-call) when any of these happen:

- 3 or more merchants report the same error within 15 minutes.
- Merchants report KP-9001, KP-9003 or KP-9007 in growing numbers.
- A payroll payout batch is stuck on pay day.
- Merchants report customers charged twice.
- The status page shows nothing but merchants say the Dashboard or API is down.

Do not wait to be sure. The on-call engineer would rather close a false alarm than miss an outage.

4. Error codes Support sees most

Code	What to do
KP-3002	Account restricted. Do not explain or guess why. Say: "Our team is reviewing the account and will contact you." Send the case to Compliance (Sofia Lindqvist) the same day.
KP-4031	Soft decline, needs 3-D Secure. If one merchant sees a lot of these, their integration is probably not sending 3-D Secure; pass it to Ravi Shah, Sales Engineer.
KP-4040	Blocked by fraud screening. Never say which rule fired or why. Offer the review form; Risk Operations answers within 1 business day.
KP-5003, KP-5004	Confirmation of Payee. The merchant must check the payee's details. We cannot override a no match.
KP-5021	Payment scheme down. Payouts retry for 4 hours on their own. Escalate as P1 if it is pay day.
KP-9007	Acquirer timeout, outcome unknown. Tell the merchant to check the payment status before retrying, and to retry only with the same idempotency key. A retry with a new key can charge the customer twice.

The full list is in the Payments API Error Code Catalogue in /Engineering/Runbooks. Ask Payments Engineering for anything not covered here.

5. Complaints

A complaint is any expression of dissatisfaction, spoken or written, about our service, whether or not the merchant uses the word "complaint".

1. Log it in the complaints register on the day you receive it.
2. Acknowledge it in writing within 1 business day.
3. Send a final response within 15 business days. In exceptional cases, send a holding reply by day 15 that explains the delay, and a final response by day 35.
4. The final response must tell eligible merchants (micro-enterprises and small businesses) that they can refer the complaint to the Financial Ombudsman Service within 6 months.

Sofia Lindqvist reviews the register every month and reports themes to the Exec.

6. What never to say

- Why an account is restricted or under review. This can be tipping off, which is a criminal offence.
- Which fraud rule blocked a payment, or any threshold.
- That a problem is "the acquirer's fault" or names a supplier, before Engineering confirms it.
- Promises of a fix time that Engineering has not given you.

7. Credits and goodwill

7.1 Checkout Pro service credits

Checkout Pro has a 99.95% monthly availability commitment. If availability falls below it, every affected Checkout Pro merchant gets a credit on the next invoice:

Monthly availability	Credit
99.0% to below 99.95%	10% of the monthly fee
95.0% to below 99.0%	25% of the monthly fee
Below 95.0%	50% of the monthly fee

Engineering confirms availability after each incident. Customer Success sends Finance AP the list of affected merchants, and the credits appear automatically on the next invoice. For INC-2026-0817 on 17 August 2026, August availability was 99.89%, so the 610 affected Checkout Pro merchants get a 10%

credit on their August invoice, due out on 5 September.

7.2 Goodwill credits

Who	Limit per merchant per quarter
Customer Success Manager	£100
Head of Sales	£500
CFO	Above £500

Record every goodwill credit in the CRM with the reason. Goodwill credits are not an admission of fault; say "as a gesture of goodwill".

8. Status page wording

Use these first messages and update them as you learn more:

- **Investigating:** "Some card payments are failing. We are investigating and will update this page within 30 minutes."
- **Identified:** "We have found the cause and are working on a fix."
- **Monitoring:** "Card payments have recovered. We are monitoring."
- **Resolved:** "This incident is resolved. If you saw duplicate charges, they will be reversed automatically within 2 business days."

9. Contacts

Need	Contact
Customer Success escalations	Hannah Kim
Integration problems	Ravi Shah, Sales Engineer
Restricted accounts, complaints	Sofia Lindqvist, Compliance Officer
Commercial disputes	Jake Morrison, Head of Sales
Outages	Payments on-call, through PagerDuty